

Vendor Onboarding Guide

Harbor & Pine Consulting · Operations · Version 1.2

1. Purpose

This guide explains how we bring a new vendor or subcontractor onto a client project, from the first request to the first payment. Follow it for every vendor so that contracts, access and payments are handled the same way each time.

2. Before you contact the vendor

- Get written approval from your manager. Any vendor expected to cost more than \$2,500 in total also needs approval from Operations.
- Check the approved vendor list. If the vendor is already listed, skip to section 4.
- Confirm with the client that they agree to a third party working on their project.

3. Vendor checks

Every new vendor completes three checks before any work starts:

- A signed services agreement and a signed confidentiality agreement on file.
- A certificate of insurance covering at least \$1,000,000 in professional liability.
- A completed information security questionnaire, reviewed by the security desk within five working days.

4. Access and tools

Vendors receive access only to the folders and tools they need, and only for the length of the project. Access is requested through Operations, never shared by email. The project manager removes access on the day the engagement ends and records it in the project tracker.

5. Payment terms

Vendors are paid net 45 days from the date we receive a correct invoice. Invoices must quote the project code and the purchase order number. Payments are made on the second Friday of each month. If a client has agreed a shorter payment term with us, the vendor term does not change.

6. Reporting problems

If a vendor misses a deadline by more than two working days, tell your manager and the client contact the same day. Do not agree to extra fees on your own. Any change to scope or price needs a written change request approved by Operations.

7. Contacts

Vendor questions: vendors@example.com or 555-0178. Security questionnaire questions: security@example.com.